WRENFORD BOROUGH COUNCIL

Defect Standard: Street Lighting

Document Standard 05 | Issue 5 | Owner: Highways Asset Management | Review cycle: every twelve months

1. Purpose and scope

This standard sets out what a report of its defect type must show before a Highways Inspector may order a repair straight from the report, and what follows the decision.

It is used by the Street Care Coordinator or Highways Inspector who opens a review, by the Highways Inspector who decides it, and by the residents, businesses, councillors, bus operators and schools who report defects, as the Highways Policy describes.

Each defect type has its own defect standard. The five defect standards share one layout and many of the same sentences; they differ in what the defect type covers, in the requirements of section 4 and how section 5 reads them, and in what an inspection records, the writing that follows a decision and the reasons that sections 6 to 9 give. A report is always reviewed under the standard of its own defect type, and under the standard of its linked defect type where it has one; a requirement in one standard never applies to a report of another defect type unless the report is linked to it.

The standard applies to every report of its defect type, whichever channel it comes through.

2. What this standard covers

This standard covers faults in the street lights the council maintains: a lamp that is out, a lamp that burns in daylight, and a column that leans.

A street light hidden by branches may be reported as a street lighting defect with vegetation as its linked defect type, or the other way round, and either way the report must meet both standards.

The defect type is Street lighting.

3. Who reports

A report is made by whoever sees the defect - a resident, a business, a councillor, a bus operator or a school - through one of three channels: the council website's report form, the StreetCare app on a phone, or a telephone call that the contact centre types up.

The report gives the street, its district and its street category, where on the street the defect is and whether that location is fixed, the defect type and any linked defect type, and the answers its requirements read. The council adds how many reports the same location has had before and the planned crew hours from its own standard times. The documents attached to a report - a resident description, a call note, a photo note or an inspection note from an earlier visit - describe the defect.

A street lighting report gives the fault, whether the lamp column number is given, the column height from the lighting inventory and, for a leaning column, its lean.

4. Requirements

Every requirement below must be Met for a Highways Inspector to order a repair straight from the report. Each requirement is stated once, in one sentence, and a report is screened against all of them, in this order:

1 **Location fixed.** The location of the defect is fixed to a house number, a lamp column number or a road junction.

2 **Column number.** The lamp column number is given on the report.

3 **Column lean.** Where the column leans, it leans at least 5.0 degrees from upright.

A requirement is never met by a sentence in a statement, and is never waived.

5. Reading the requirements

Each requirement is Met, Not met or Not documented on the report as the Report Rules read it. The latest revision of a report is the report; an earlier revision is never screened.

- A location is fixed when the report ties the defect to a house number, a lamp column number or a road junction, so that a crew can find it without a search. The requirement is met when the report records the location fixed, not met when it records that it is not, and not documented when the answer is blank.
- The lamp column number is plated on every column the council maintains and tells a crew which column to go to. The requirement is met when the report records the column number given, not met when it records that it is not, and not documented when the answer is blank.
- The column lean is a follow-on question, decided by the fault. For a lamp that is out or burns in daylight it is met whatever else the report says. For a leaning column it is met when the lean is at least the figure from upright, in degrees to one decimal, not met when it leans less, and not documented when the lean is blank. A blank fault is not documented and asks for the fault alone.

A requirement that is not documented names the answers it needs, so that the inspection can find them.

A report with a linked defect type is screened under this standard and under the linked type's, and must meet both. The documents never decide a requirement. A measurement sentence whose figure differs from the report's own, or gives a figure the report left blank, is flagged for the Highways Inspector, and the report's answer still decides.

6. What an inspection records

When a report is sent for inspection on site, the inspector who visits records what this standard needs to decide the repair: the fault, the lamp column number from its plate, the column height from the lighting inventory, the lean measured with a level for a leaning column, and the location fixed to a house number, a lamp column or a junction.

7. The works order

The works order goes to the council's repair contractor when a Highways Inspector orders a repair under this standard. It names the report by its report reference and defect type, says the repair is ordered, and gives the street, the location, the defect's own measurements and the repair this section names: a lamp replacement for a lamp that is out, a photocell replacement for a lamp that burns in daylight, or a column replacement for a leaning column. A linked defect type is named with its own repair. It asks the contractor to leave the light working and the column door locked. The works order carries no figure from a model.

8. The resident update

The resident update is written after the works order, for the person who reported the defect. It tells them in plain words that a repair has been ordered, what will be done and where. For a street light it says that the light will be repaired, or the column replaced where it leans. Where the repair depends on a linked defect, the update says so. The update never gives the repeat likelihood, the expected crew hours or any other figure from a model, never promises when the work will be done, and never names any member of the council's staff.

9. Why these requirements

A lamp that is out leaves a footway dark, and the lamp column number tells a crew which column to go to. A lamp that burns in daylight has a failed photocell, and its repair is ordered from the report in the same way.

A column leaning at least the figure of section 4 must be replaced before it falls. A smaller lean is inspected on site, where a structural check decides.

Highways Asset Management owns this standard, reviews it every twelve months and issues any amendment as a new issue of this document, replacing every earlier issue.